

Friendship Circle, Montessori,
Work with kids

Assignment 3 -17/SP ELC-721-17SPI
by [Judith Orloff](#) - Wednesday, February 15, 2017, 1:23 PM

ForLee Mahon - Assignment 3, Judith Orloff

Dissolving Adverse Childhood Conditioning through a Mindfulness curriculum for parents and children from Preschool through High School

The problem I am addressing is the inordinate use of drugs, violence, and lack of clarity in young people and the detachments they feel from adults, parents, teachers, etc. The neighborhood is no longer safe. The community is unresponsive to their needs. People of color and women are objectified more as their consciousness grows and these groups become less internally subjugated and more aware of their options. There are no universal tools that can mitigate this violence of mind, heart, body and spirit. There is a proliferation of different therapeutic tools, classes, evidence based models, etc. that support individuals and families. I would like my research and curriculum to be part of that great body of work. I haven't decided what age group to focus on now.

For the past 45 years, I have been exploring methodologies to dissolve negative childhood conditioning. Childhood messages stay subliminally, unknowingly creating deeply reactive responses to situations that may unconsciously be reminiscent to the person or group of what their childhood conditions were. Their survival strategies learned as children take center stage for the moment. The either/or way of thinking takes over and they go into a "trance state" as Four Arrows discusses, and cannot see what is occurring at that moment. Working individually or with a group of people, both children and adults, I have could teach a process of self-awareness that allows them to have new choices rather than succumb to a survival based either/or way of viewing the world.

I wish to create a mindfulness/ self-awareness curriculum for parents and children beginning in pre-school and continuing through high school. For my Theories of Change class with Nicola this semester, I will be exploring Theories of Change with Montessori early childhood education

As a young parent, I didn't understand or even consider how my behavior would affect my children as they developed. *The secret life of the unborn child*, by Thomas Verny, M.D, and John Kelly, 1982, posit the fetus becomes aware and conscious between three to six months in the womb. There are many discussions in the book and the sources described that elaborate on that perspective.

At this time, I have decided to use Phenomenology as my foremost methodology for my dissertation and am preparing a Prezi for Anna's class.

References;

The Secret Life of the Unborn Child, Thomas Verny, M.D. and Johyn Kelly, 1982

Socioemotional development in the toddler years, edited by Celia A. Brownell, Claire B. Kopp, p.134" contrary to previous belief, conditioning is possible in newborns, Ganchrow & Steiner, 1984.

Birth without Violence, Frederick Leboyer, 1974

James, D. K. (2010), Fetal learning: a critical review. *Inf. Child Develop.*, 19: 45-54.
doi:10.1002/icd.653

Lubavitch Friendship Circle

1, people
to interview
at their
end.
5 of each
Teenager
Kids



Draft Enrollment Concept

25 minute pres.
with 3 add'rs.

Assumptions:

1. We will conduct interviews with
 - Jewish Teenagers in Colorado to see what can motivate them to want to do this form of volunteering and to see what music they listen to
 - Teens that are already in Friendship Circles to see why they did it, what the experience is like and what it means to them.
 - Disabled children who are in the program and those who are not.
2. We will incorporate the findings into the design of the program.
3. We will create several versions of slide show for more observant, less observant and non-Jewish audiences.
4. The expenses incurred in the creation of the slide show, video and materials as well as travel expenses are additional. (Will get estimate)
5. Judith will train the presenter rabbis in how to set context and conduct debriefs to get the desired response.

First guess time estimates:

Interviews and synthesis of findings	12 hours
Slide show (need to decide if using stock photos or taking new pictures) – three versions	40 hours
Design program activities	15 hours
Shoot/edit video	20 hours
Create instructor materials for pilot	15 hours
Create train-the-trainer program and materials	20 hours
Conduct train-the-trainer program	10 hours

Produce program-in-a-box kits (5)	15 hours
Total hours	147 hours (initial estimate)

Estimate of Investment

\$5,000 for design and development of program and ttt.

\$500 to \$1,000 per center to use program, depending on size.

Hard cost expenses such as printing, travel, etc. additional.

Opening
5 minutes

Rabbi sets a context of openness by how he interacts from the outset. This context will depend on the audience. We will write different openings based on this; For example, for a Jewish group, we will subtly address the Rebbe's thoughts, for a non-Jewish group we will word things differently.,

We show slide show

- Shots of "normal" adolescents and young children doing various physical activities interspersed with shots of "disabled" children or adolescents doing similar activities.
- The shots change more and more quickly until they start to blur and it is not easy to see who is who.
- The slide show is set to music that is popular with teenagers but with new words that we will write to set the environment we want to create
- After the slide show we ask the participants to turn to person next to them and share what they saw. The important verb is "see".

use their video.

Activity
5 minutes

Rabbi asks the class to share what they saw and to list the things they love to do and the things they can't stand to do. He captures the ideas all on a flipchart.

Debrief
5 minutes

Then he leads the class in getting down to the core of what they love (being with friends) and the core of what they can't stand (being isolated and without friends.) *We write the debrief so that this information comes through.*

Video
5 minutes

We show a video of different shots of teenagers (both "normal" and disabled) talking about their hopes, dreams and fears. They are all very similar. *They match what was discovered in the previous activity.*

For now.

Wrap-up
5 minutes

- The rabbi leads a discussion of
- When do they feel the best about themselves (*when giving*)
 - What do they see as their responsibility in creating the world a better place (*giving, speaking up against*)

inequities, taking stands, etc.

- The likeness in what they hate and like
- The likeness in their hopes, fears and dreams
- What action will they choose to take to make other teens or children not feel alone? And, what does that mean to them?
- What does commitment mean? *They have a handout to take away from the program, a poem on commitment that was written during a mountain climbing expedition They have probably read it before, but it is signed by the presenter and is on parchment like paper.*

After this there is a sign up and we end. This is approximately 25 to 30 minutes.

Extended Time Options

Additional activities:

- The Gloves of Arthritis – we have them put on soaped over glasses, foam earplugs and rubber gloves with the fingers stuffed with popsicle sticks and cotton. Then we ask them to try to button a shirt or dial a phone. The intent is to give them an experience of being disabled so that they will have empathy for the disabled.
- A trust walk – we blindfold them and have someone walk them through an obstacle course while saying scripted comments. Again the intent is to give them an experience of being disabled so that they will have empathy for the disabled.
- They are Disabled exercise – we ask them to imagine themselves learning that they have just become disabled . How will they live their life differently? What are their needs now? This activity gives them a chance to look at what is important to them.

1 1/2 hr.
the horrible thing
20 minutes

Disabilities Sensitivity Training and Anti-Bullying Workshop

History

The Friendship Circle, founded in 1994 in Detroit, Michigan, extends a helping hand to families who have children and teenagers with special needs, ranging from muscular dystrophy to autism, and involves them in a full range of social, recreational and respite opportunities.

The Friendship Circle also fills a vital need for meaningful volunteer opportunities for teenagers who, with the support of professional social workers, provide the respite and friendship to the families and children. All teen volunteers participate in intensive training, including onsite guidance and seminars given by professionals in the field.

Through this unique formula of shared experiences, all are enriched:

- The child/teen with special needs looks forward to the opportunity to play with and learn from their friends and appreciates the companionship of peers which is often times lacking in their lives.
- The teenage volunteer learns the value of giving, and cherishes the experience of making a difference in a child's life and bringing a smile to his or her face.
- The child's family receives a needed respite and the pleasure of seeing their child become a part of the community.

The Friendship Circle programs include home respite visits, music, sports and art therapy programs, summer and winter camps, and much more.

The Detroit model has since been replicated in 42 cities across the United States, with many others looking to start the program in the near future. Currently, more than 3,000 families who have children with special needs benefit from our programs. The teen volunteer club boasts 5,500 members nationwide and is growing. The impact of the Friendship Circle is multiplied by the friendships and support system that grows between the families of the volunteers and the special needs families. Thus by extension the Circle actually includes tens of thousands of people.

Each independent Friendship Circle is operated by its local center, and all operations and programs are supported entirely by the local community of each Friendship Circle. However, all the centers work closely together to share resources, materials and ideas. The New Jersey, Pennsylvania and Michigan offices are coordinating this initiative.

Proposed Workshop

Our experience has given us a keen understanding of the positive impact that individuals and the community at large can have on people with disabilities and their families and the impact that these children and families have on the teen volunteers. We are looking to expand this effect through a multi-media interactive workshop to be presented at middle and high schools across the country.

The workshop will focus on creating a general awareness about persons with physical and mental disabilities, highlighting their similarities to the teenagers in the audience as well as their differences. The goal of the program is to break down barriers between people with disabilities and those in the community unaware of how to approach and befriend each other while stressing the beneficial impact of a positive attitude.

Notes from Friendship Circle Conference Call May 18, 2004

On the call were Rabbi Zalman Grossbaum, Rabbi Yudi Shemtov, Judith Orloff and Sarah Cardet

Judith opened by talking about a contact of hers that could be a possible resource for this project who works with people with disabilities. His website is www.mtc-inc.com.

Discussion points:

Zalman

- This is broader than just a recruitment tool.
- He wants to get clear before signing a contract so we don't get down the road and discover we are not aligned.
- He wants this to be sensitivity training and have recruitment be an end result.
- He discovered major philosophical issues on the Normemma website that struck him as very powerful
- He wants Norm and Emma on board on the project to help with content but not with how the material is presented. Then at the end of the development he wants them to see and approve the program
- Not only does he want their endorsement but he wants their ideas

General

- We want to create a paradigm shift regarding people with disabilities.
- Disabled people are essentially the same as everyone else with an added gift/challenge and lesson to offer others
- We see the sensitivity training as valuable in schools not just to sensitize the students to seeing disabled people as equals but also to help reduce the incidence of bullying
- Judith spoke about her understanding of Norm's point of view and how valuable it is and we discussed arranging a conference call soon
- We envision a 30 minute "teaser" to introduce the program to decision-makers
- We spoke of the current concept being true to the Rebbe's vision
- Judith and Sarah will create another contract for consideration incorporating the ideas from this conference call and some of the language from Zalman's grant proposal and send to Zalman and Yudi by some time this week.
- Judith stated that the development cost will most likely be different for the new concept

Sensitizing teenagers to the challenges that people with disabilities face and making them aware of the commonalities that unite us all is the first step towards providing an overall respect for each person's differences, be they physical, racial, socioeconomic or otherwise, and providing teenagers with the skills necessary for looking beyond differences to find the similarities that friendships can be built on. With sensitivity and the ability to reach out to others, teenagers are much less likely to bully their peers as this behavior is most often the outgrowth of a lack of sensitivity and a sense that differences are inherently bad and often times insurmountable. Instead teenagers are encouraged to find common ground with each other and form friendships.

The positive effect of disability sensitivity training on teenagers and the resulting decrease in bullying behavior has been evidenced so far in our research. We have found that teens who volunteer with the Friendship Circle and other similar programs have also become more respectful and understanding towards peers who are labeled as "outcasts" because of their differences. In addition, these volunteers are much less likely to engage in bullying activities when compared to the overall communal and school population.

The proposed one-day workshop will include discussions, improvisational exercises and videos directed by a trained facilitator to help involve the teens in the learning process. Each participant will be asked to assume scenarios and navigate challenges that are routinely experienced by people with disabilities and to engage in discussions and develop ideas for surpassing these situations. The facilitator will then engage the teenagers to translate the lessons learned from these experiences to the differences and challenges faced by those within the teens' peer groups and community. Communication skills will be emphasized, modeled and rewarded.

Plan of Action

We have enlisted the help of Orloff Consulting of Boulder, Colorado to create the workshop. We are in the process of involving nationally recognized authorities who specialize in disability awareness to assist with the creative process.

We are looking to run this workshop as a pilot program through the Friendship Circles in California, Michigan, New Jersey and Pennsylvania. During the first four months, we will run 30 workshops at various public and private middle and high schools. We will work with participating educators and teens to perfect the program and to maximize its effectiveness.

Once the presentation is fine-tuned, we will launch the program nationally. We anticipate reaching 15,000 teenagers during the first year and doubling that amount in the first three years.

Funding

We are looking for seed money for the creative process and for the pilot program. Each independent Friendship Circle will find local grants and other sources of funding to implement the program in their city.

Contact

Friendship Circle
Rabbi Zalman Grossbaum, Executive Director
61 N. Ashby Avenue
Livingston, NJ 07039
Office: 973-597-0618 Cell: 973-420-6808
zalman@fcnj.com
www.fcnj.com

Friendship Circle

Sensitivity Training



Contract

Friendship Circle

The Situation

The Rebbe wrote, "Anyone dealing with retarded individuals should start from the basic premise that the retardation is in each case only temporary, and that in due course, it could certainly be improved, and even improved substantially. This approach should be taken regardless of the pronouncements or prognosis of specialists in the field. The reason for this approach is, first of all, that it is a precondition for greater success in dealing with the handicapped." We believe the Rebbe's words apply to dealing with handicaps of any kind in children. And that today's teenagers have as much to gain as to give when working with handicapped children or teens.

Right now Friendship Circle is bringing their recruitment meetings into a room of 50--75 teenagers many of which are only there because it is a reason to get out of class. We are not dealing with an audience of people that have already volunteered. We are usually dealing with a captive audience that is there because they have to be. With such a high level of forced choice with the participants, you run the risk of bombing out simply because there is a strong possibility that many will not participate. In many cases, because they do not really "get" the value of the commitment.

We want each teenager to leave with a positive experience even if they do not "sign up" as a volunteer.

The Presentation Concept

The purpose of The Friendship Circle Recruitment Presentation is to provide the rabbis who initiate this program with a highly experiential format that will engage the whole person - body and soul. We can make the learning very deep while having it appear simple.

While the course content has yet to be developed, here is the preliminary outline for the presentation:

Friendship Circle

Opening
5 minutes

Rabbi sets a context of openness by how he interacts from the outset.

He starts with a discussion about the eyes of a teenager and what they are able to perceive. And that parents in general have lost the ability to perceive in the same way. He demonstrates this with provocative questions and information.

Video
5 minutes

We show the existing video. We give out the words of the song that is on the video so that the students can follow.

- After the slide show, we ask the participants to turn to person next to them and share what they saw. We emphasize the word "saw".
- We can also ask the large group to answer the same question and address the answer to the front of the room.
- We can ask a volunteer to write on a flip chart so that the Rabbi can face the audience while the answers are being written.

Activity
5 minutes

Rabbi asks the class to list the things they love to do and the things they can't stand to do. He captures the ideas all on a flipchart.

Debrief
5 minutes

Then he leads the class in getting down to the core of what they love (being with friends) and the core of what they can't stand (being isolated and without friends.)

- He leads the discussion to talking about their hopes, dreams and fears. They are all very similar.
- The point is then made that these dreams and hopes are the same as any person, handicapped or not.

Wrap-up
5 minutes

The rabbi leads a discussion of

- When do they feel the best about themselves (*when giving*)
- What do they see as their responsibility in creating the world a better place (*giving, speaking up against*)

Friendship Circle

inequities, taking stands, etc.

- The likeness in what they hate and like
- The likeness in their hopes, fears and dreams
- What action will they choose to take to make other teens or children not feel alone? And, what does that mean to them?
- What does commitment mean? *They have a handout to take away from the program, a poem on commitment that was written during a mountain climbing expedition. It is signed by the presenter and is on parchment like paper.*

After we end. This is approximately 25 to 30 minutes.

Additional Options

We will create an additional activity for use whenever time is expanded. This activity will take 20 minutes.

Being Disabled exercise - we ask them to imagine themselves learning that they have just become disabled. How will they live their life differently? What are their needs now? This activity gives them a chance to look at what is important to them.

We also propose two activities that could be used after the volunteers have signed up to help prepare them for the actual experience:

The Gloves of Arthritis - we have them put on soaped over glasses, foam earplugs and rubber gloves with the fingers stuffed with Popsicle sticks and cotton. Then we ask them to try to button a shirt or dial a phone. The intent is to give them an experience of being disabled so that they will have empathy for the disabled.

The Hitchhiker (role play) - they are asked to envision being on a road trip with their parents and in the near distance a hitchhiker appears with a dog. The parents see a potentially dangerous, scruffy person to be avoided. They see a fellow human in need that is obviously trustworthy because his dog is well cared for. How do they resolve the discrepancy in perception and convince the parents to give the hitchhiker a chance?

Friendship Circle

Facilitator Training

The Friendship Circle Recruitment Presentation requires a facilitator who is able to:

- Tolerate how they feel while conflict is going on
- Allow for discovery on the participants' part
- Accept participants questioning what they themselves may never have questioned
- Create a safe and compassionate environment for people who are wrestling with emotions.

Deliverables

The project deliverables include the following:

- Recruitment program.
- All presentation materials.
- Train-the-Trainer program for the presenters.

Friendship Circle

Assumptions

1. We will conduct interviews with
 - Jewish Teenagers in Colorado to see what can motivate them to want to do this form of volunteering and to see what music they listen to
 - Teens that are already in Friendship Circles to see why they did it, what the experience is like and what it means to them.
 - Disabled children who are in the program and those who are not.
 - Parents of disabled children who are in the program
2. We will incorporate the findings into the design of the program.
3. We will initially use the existing video.
4. The expenses incurred in the creation of the program, and materials as well as travel expenses are additional. (Will get estimate)
5. Judith will train the presenter rabbis in how to set context and conduct debriefs to get the desired response.

Friendship Circle

Investment

The project cost as defined herein is \$5,000 for design and development of program and one day of facilitator training payable as follows:

- One half upon signing contract
- One quarter upon completion of materials
- One quarter upon completion of facilitator training if done in June at meeting. Otherwise, an agreed upon time between both parties. Our expectation is to have the program completed before your June conference.

In addition, Orloff Consulting will initially be paid \$500 to \$1,000 per center to use program, depending on size for the first 10 centers to sign on. After the first ten, the cost will be \$750 to \$1500 per center to use program, depending on size.

Hard cost expenses such as graphic design, printing, and materials, travel, etc. are additional.

Should Friendship Circle require additional training beyond that provided the Coaching Session under this Agreement may charge additional fees.

In addition to the provisions of this Agreement, should Friendship Circle ask for changes to the seminar not originally contemplated by this contract, the timetable or any other materials, etc., additional fees may be charged for these "Change Orders." Fees and costs resulting from Change Orders to the seminar will be negotiated as needed.

Time Line

	Phase	Events & Deliverables	Duration	Timeline
1	Research	We will gather the contextual information, and issues.	2 weeks	Early May
2	Design	Core content, learning objectives and activities, for client approval.	2 weeks	Late May
3	Development	We develop Instructor materials, Graphics, and	2 weeks	Early June

Friendship Circle

Judith Orloff

From: Rabbi Yehuda Shemtov [yshemtov@earthlink.net]
Sent: Thursday, January 15, 2004 7:45 AM
To: Judith Orloff
Cc: Zalman@NJJewish.com
Subject: RE: FC PowerPoint Presentation

hi judith,
i have answered to the best of my ability. i have also cc'd this to rabbi zalman grossbaum one of the leaders of this program. i think he should be part of all correspondence on this project.

zalman- can you add your views on these issues?

thanks for your time,
rs

-----Original Message-----

From: Judith Orloff [mailto:jorloff@o-dconsulting.com]
Sent: Monday, January 12, 2004 3:56 PM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net
Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

Hi-

I need to know more about the needs of the target audience and the time increments for which they need something. For example:

- What is the Friendship Circle? Is that the two on one relationship?

FC is the general program that entails three parts: the 2-1 meetings.
bi weekly meetings on sudays and special events throughout the year. check www.fcnj.com for more info

- Who is going to be using this in the friendship circle? Counselors, facilitators, volunteers? Is this just the Rabbi's who will be presenting it?

either rabbis facilitators or general recruitment volunteers, this is a recruitment tool for teenage volunteers.

- What is their perceived need? Why would they each be willing to pay \$1000?

so they have a good tool to recruit quality children into the program. i am not sure everybody will pay the \$1,000. i would others may pay \$500 to have this created for them.

- Is it several scenarios for short one-on-one meetings? Can it be a several hour class? I have many different ideas for different time frames and people who will present.

3/28/2004

i would not say several hours. i would suggest 45 minute presentation to group of potential volunteers.

- Do the people using this powerful enrollment process need training? Will they be willing to be trained by phone?

depends what you come up with. FC runs conferences for all its affiliate branches once or twice a year (with one in the summer) maybe that would be a good training opp.

Yudi, I am guessing you may not know these answers, but if you could guess, that will be great.

B'shalom

judith

-----Original Message-----

From: Rabbi Yehuda Shemtov [mailto:yshemtov@earthlink.net]

Sent: Sunday, November 30, 2003 7:00 AM

To: jorloff@o-dconsulting.com

Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

hi judith,

long time no hear.

i have little project that you may be able to help us with. we need a presentation for teenagers. we have a project called friendship circle that pairs up two teen agers with a special needs child. these teenagers will visit once a week and become the child's friend.

we would like to create a powerful enrollment process to get teen age kids motivated and excited about this and let them know how great an impact they will be making for these special needs children. i need accelerated learning for teenagers.

any ideas?

have a good shabbos.

yudy

ps: attached is something a friend of mine who is doing the sme project tried. obviously we need something more impactful...

-----Original Message-----

From: Rabbi Zalman Grossbaum [mailto:Zalman@NJJewish.com]

3/28/2004

Sent: Friday, November 07, 2003 12:51 AM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net
Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

Hi Yudi:

Thanks for your help. Let me know if you want me to talk to her on a conference call.

Zalman

You can make a difference

What does it mean to be a child with special needs?

How does it feel?

- I would have no friends
- I would be lonely
- I would be sad
- My parents would cry for me...
- My siblings would be embarrassed
- My phone wouldn't ring
- I wouldn't be going out to the mall

It should be interactive.....

YOU can change my life.

How...

- Being friend
- Come to my home
- Ring my phone
- Send me an e-mail
- Do a project with me
- Play basketball with me..
- Love me for who I am.

I know I may seem different but I am still like you.....

Script to along to presenter.

Quotes from volunteers

Quotes from parents how changed their family life - Were' alone but you can change our life forever

List of programs

- Visiting a child in his /her home
- Hanging out with a friend at Children's Circle
- Making A difference - Meaning

Volunteer Club

Incentives

All the volunteers have a common denominator. We all give up social extra's just to volunteer. These teens are special and we admire you and respect you and therefore we have all these incentives

Making them aware of what is out there and that they can make a difference

Find out about FC and let them make a choice give them an opportunity and want to give them enough info. To inspire and at the same time kids can realize that it may not be for them.

Be my friend I can be yours too

Points

Spell out the commitment. What does it take to be a committed volunteer

Opening 1	Talking Points
Meet Lindsay. She likes to hangout with friends.	Like you, Lindsay wants to have friends. But it's harder for Lindsay to make friends than it is for you. Could you be the friend that Lindsay is looking for?
Closing 1	
Join the Friendship Circle.	Imagine Lindsay looking up to you. There are many children like Lindsay waiting for a friend.
Opening 2	
Think of the three most important things in your life.	I bet one of the three is "friends." We all need friends. Friends are important, we can count on them. Children with special needs may not have the opportunities you have to make friends. That's why we created the Friendship Circle.
Closing 2	
Friends. We all need them. Join the Friendship Circle.	Do you have room in your life for one more?
Opening 3	
We have a special Circle of Jewish friends and there's room in the Circle for you.	Come, reach out and join the Friendship Circle. Half of the Circle is made up of teens like you. Teens who already have plenty of friends but have room in their hearts for one more. The other half is made up of children with special needs.
Closing 3	
There's a place for you. Join the Friendship Circle.	The Circle will not be complete until you are in it.
Opening 4	
This is Sam, Jake and Aaron. They're friends.	Sam used to be lonely. Then he met Jake and Aaron. They taught him to play soccer and baseball. They visit him every week. Children with special needs, like Sam, may not have the opportunity to make friends as easily as you do. That's why we have the Friendship Circle.
Closing 4	
Join the Friendship Circle.	Could you be a friend to a great kid like Sam? Just like Jake and Aaron, you could make someone very happy by being a friend and mentor.

Judith Orloff

From: Rabbi Zalman Grossbaum [Zalman@NJJewish.com]
Sent: Thursday, January 15, 2004 9:02 AM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net; 'Judith Orloff'
Subject: RE: FC PowerPoint Presentation
Follow Up Flag: Follow up
Flag Status: Flagged

Hi Yudi:

You did a fine job answering, but let me add a few details that be helpful. Maybe we should setup a conference call so that Judith does not get one-line answers and would have a chance to understand the emotional nuances of the FC.

Zalman

Please see answers below.

-----Original Message-----

From: Judith Orloff [mailto:jorloff@o-dconsulting.com]
Sent: Monday, January 12, 2004 3:56 PM
To: yshemtov@earthlink.net
Subject: FW: FC PowerPoint Presentation

I need to know more about the needs of the target audience and the time increments for which they need something. For example:

- What is the Friendship Circle? Is that the two on one relationship?

Part of the beauty of what the FC offers is the various opportunities to volunteer. I would like the presentation to be relevant to all the teens that might be watching.

We have our weekly home visits, bi-weekly Sunday programs, evening and weekend sports programs, seasonal holiday programs, and soon (when we have our center) we will have something each evening. (Although many of the FCs are not as established as us, they still do offer a variety and will in short time offer more options.)

One of the unique benefits of the FC is the relationship that the teens build with the kids and the effect that has on the teens. Most other volunteer opportunities are one-time deals.

Additionally, I would like to speak to the other student who and try to influence them about being more understanding of people with disabilities - including classmates who might have learning disabilities or "social disabilities". Being a FC volunteer is not an exclusionary club - everyone in their own lives can make a difference to the child down the block or their own classmates.

- Who is going to be using this in the friendship circle? Counselors, facilitators, volunteers? Is this just the Rabbi's who will be presenting it?

either rabbis facilitators or general recruitment volunteers, this is a recruitment tool for teenage volunteers.

In our situation we do not do any more recruiting (since we have more than enough teens coming to

3/28/2004

us). I would use the presentation as an intro for the FC for volunteers that have already registered.

- What is their perceived need? Why would they each be willing to pay \$1000?

so they have a good tool to recruit quality children into the program. i am not sure everybody will pay the \$1,000. i would others may pay \$500 to have this created for them.

Being that there are so many communities already running the FC (28 to be exact) and many others who are considering it, the cost would be very nominal for each location to absorb.

- Is it several scenarios for short one-on-one meetings? Can it be a several hour class? I have many different ideas for different time frames and people who will present.

i would not say several hours. i would suggest 45 minute presentation to group of potential volunteers.

Most times when you go into a school to do a presentation they will only give you 15-20 minutes. I think that the presentation needs to be geared to that time frame, but with enough flexibility to be able to use it for a 45 minute presentation.

When used for the shorter presentation it would be a hard-hitting style with an overload of information to try and convince the teens that the FC is the best thing since sliced bread. The same presentation would also be adaptable to longer presentations by the presenter adding more content for each frame.

- Do the people using this powerful enrollment process need training? Will they be willing to be trained by phone?

depends what you come up with. FC runs conferences for all its affiliate branches once or twice a year (with one in the summer) maybe that would be a good training opp.

The problem is that not everyone comes to the conference. In the past the conference was geared towards new cities looking to start the program. Maybe we can highlight the next conference with this presentation. (I think that would bring out a lot of people.

The best option might be to include talking notes or full script for the presenters. It would be best if we could also create a video to show them how to use the presentation.

Being that they are teens (with short attention spans) we have to make sure that the presentation is multi-sensory. We could include thought provoking questions, interestingly presented statistics, video clips, etc. We also have to make sure that every teen in the crowd will be able to relate to the teens in the presentation (hip enough, etc.)

Hope these thoughts help,

Zalman

The Rebbe Writes

22 Av, 5739 [1979]

Greeting and Blessing,

This is in reply to your letter of Aug. 9, in which you ask for my views on "the care and education of Jewish retarded children," outlining some of the problems connected therewith and prevailing policies, etc.

I must first of all, make one essential observation, namely, that while the above heading places all the retarded in one group, it would be a gross fallacy to come up with any rules to be applied to all of them as a group. For if any child requires an individual evaluation and approach in order to achieve the utmost in his or her development, how much more so in the case of the handicapped.

Since the above is so obvious, I assume that you have in mind the most general guidelines, with a wide range of flexibility allowing for the necessary individual approach in each case. All the more so, since, sad to say, our present society is poorly equipped in terms of manpower and financial resources to afford an adequate personal approach to each handicapped boy and girl. Even more regrettable is the fact that little attention (at any rate, little in relation to the importance of the problem) is given to this situation, and consequently little is done to mobilize more adequate resources to deal with the problem.

Now, with regard to general guidelines, I would suggest the following:

1. The social worker, or teacher, and anyone dealing with retarded individuals should start from the basic premise that the retardation is in each case only a temporary handicap, and that in due course it could certainly be improved, and even improved substantially. This approach should be taken regardless of the pronouncements or prognosis of specialists in the field. The reason for this approach is, first of all, that it is a precondition for greater success in dealing with the retarded.

Besides, considering the enormous strides that have been made in medical science, human knowledge, methodology and know-how, there is no doubt that in this area, too, there will be far-reaching developments. Thus, the very confidence that such progress is in the realm of possibility, will inspire greater enthusiasm in this work, and hopefully will also stimulate more intensive research.

2. Just as the said approach is important from the viewpoint of and for the worker and educator, so it is important that the trainees themselves should be encouraged - both by word and the manner of their training - to feel confident that they are not, G-d forbid, "cases," much less unfortunate or hopeless cases, that their difficulty is considered, as above, only temporary, and that with a concerted effort of instructor and trainee the desired improvement could be speeded and enhanced.

3. Needless to say, care should be taken not to exaggerate expectations through far-fetched promises, for false hopes inevitably result in deep disenchantment, loss of credibility and other undesirable effects. However, a way can surely be found to avoid raising false hopes, yet giving guarded encouragement.

4. Part of the above approach which, as far as I know has not been used before, is to involve some of the trainees in some form of leadership, such as captains of teams, group leaders, and the like, without arousing the jealousy of the others. The latter could be avoided by making such selections on the basis of seniority, special achievement, exemplary conduct, etc.

5. With regard to the efforts which have been made in recent years to create "group homes" for retarded individuals, which, as you say, has been a source of controversy - it is to be expected that, as in most things in our imperfect world, there are pros and cons. However, I believe that the approach should be the same as in the case of all pupils or students who spend part of their time in group environments - school, dormitory, summer camp, etc., and part of their time in the midst of their families, whether every day, or on weekends, etc. Only by individual approach and evaluation can it be determined which individual fits into which category.

6. There is surely no need to emphasize at length that, as in all cases involving Jews, their specific Jewish needs must be taken into account. This is particularly true in the case of retarded Jewish children, yet all too often disregarded. There is unfortunately a prevalent misconception that since you are dealing with retarded children, having more limited capabilities, they should not be "burdened" with Jewish education on top of their general education, so as not to overtax them. In my opinion this is a fallacious and detrimental attitude, especially in light of what has been said above about the need to avoid impressing the child with his handicap.

Be it remembered that a child coming from a Jewish home probably has brothers and sisters, or cousins and friends, who receive a Jewish education and are exposed to Jewish observances. Even in the American society, where observant Jews are not in the majority, there is always some measure of Jewish experience, or Jewish angle, in the child's background. Now therefore, if the retarded child sees or feels that he has been singled out and removed from that experience, or when he will eventually find out that he Jewish, yet deprived of his Jewish identity and heritage - it is very likely to cause irreparable damage to him.

On the other hand, if the child is involved in Jewish education and activities - and not in some general and peripheral way, but in a regular and tangible way, such as in the actual performance of Mitzvos, customs and traditions, it would give him a sense of belonging and attachment, and a firm anchorage to hold on to, whether consciously or subconsciously. Eventually even a subconscious feeling of inner security would pass into the conscious state, especially if the teacher will endeavor to cultivate and fortify this feeling.

I am, of course, aware of the arguments that may be put forth in regard to this idea, namely, that it would require additional funding, qualified personnel, etc., not readily available at present. To be sure, these are arguments that have a basis in fact as things now stand.

However, the real problem is not so much the lack of resources as the prevailing attitude that considers the Jewish angle as of secondary importance, or less; consequently the effort to remedy the situation is commensurate, resulting in a self-fulfilling prophecy. The truth of the matter is that if the importance of it would be seen in its true light - that it is an essential factor in the development of the retarded Jewish child, in addition to our elementary obligation to all Jewish children without exception, the results would be quite different.

Perhaps all the aforesaid is not what you had in mind in soliciting views on "group homes." Nevertheless, I was impelled to dwell on the subject at some length, not only because it had to be said, but also because it may serve as a basis for solving the controversy surrounding the creation of "group homes" for those children who are presently placed in an environment often quite distant from the individual's home and community, to paraphrase your statement.

Finally, a concluding remark relating to your laudatory reference to the Lubavitch movement, "with its deep concern for every Jewish individual's welfare." etc.

Needless to say, such appreciation is very gratifying, but I must confess and emphasize that this is not an original Lubavitch idea, for it is basic to Torah Judaism. Thus, our Sages of old declared that "Ve'ohavta Lereacha Kamocha" ("Love your fellow as yourself") is the Great Principle of our Torah, with the accent on "as yourself," since every person surely has a very special, personal approach to himself. To the credit of the Lubavitch emissaries it may be said, however, that they are doing all they can to implement and live by this Golden Rule of the Torah, and doing it untiringly and enthusiastically.

May the Zechus Horabim - the merit of the many who benefit from your sincere efforts to help them in their need, especially in your capacity as Regional Chairman of the Council For Mental Retardation - stand you in good stead to succeed in the fullest measure and stimulate your dedication for even greater achievements.

With esteem and blessing,

Judith Orloff

Paper on Change Assessment for Montessori
Teacher Training

ELC-726: Theories of Change

Assessment of Montessori Teacher Training using Theories of Change

“The training of the teacher is something far more than learning ideas. It includes training of character. It is a preparation of the spirit.” Marie Montessori

My interest in obtaining a doctorate at Fielding Graduate University is to pursue my dream and professional mission of “cracking the code” of childhood conditioning, particularly the negative beliefs and inner voices that continue to plague an individual throughout their lives.

My idea is to partner with other scholar practitioners, review the literature of programs and organizations wishing to dissolve negative childhood conditioning and develop a Mindfulness Curriculum for parents and children to facilitate this dream. I have called this curriculum Disruptive Learning Technology.

I have been interested in the Montessori Method of teacher training primarily because of its focus on self-awareness, self-assessment and observation through non-judgment. I decided to explore that through the lens of Theory of Change. The inquiry in this paper is, to see how Theories of Change can be used to explore the Montessori assessment schema to evaluate teacher's accomplishments in the Montessori educational model.

I will not compare the differences between traditional and Montessori teacher training. I also will not focus on the children schooled in Montessori education. Because of the nature of an assessment schema, it seems to me we are looking at skills that can be measured by observation and testing, and the Montessori Paradigm, which seems more difficult and elusive to assess.

We each have ontological restraints based on our background, and training and are conditioned at a very early age to evaluate rather than assess how progress is being made both in individual students and in organizations. However, in the Montessori method of teacher training, the most important skill demanded is for each teacher training candidate to learn to be mindful and inner directed as this is one of the most pronounced feature of Montessori Education.

“To be mindful is to be non-judgmental: one is to notice, but not make good-bad judgments. “Mindfulness is cultivated by assuring the stance of an impartial witness to your own experience. To do this requires that you become aware of the constant stream of judging...and learn to step back from it” (Kabat-Zinn 1990, p. 33).

For purposes of this assessment of change paper, assessment is the process of objectively understanding the state or condition of a thing, by observation and measurement. Assessment of teaching means taking a measure of its “effectiveness.” Whereas, Evaluation is the process of observing and measuring a thing to judging it and to determine its “value,” either by comparison to similar things, or to a standard. Evaluation of teaching means passing judgment on it as part of an administrative process. (institute for teaching learning and Academic leadership, University at Albany state university of New York.)

First, I will provide a simple definition of what Theory of Change is and how it will be used in this paper.

“A theory of change (TOC) is the product of a series of critical-thinking exercises that provide a comprehensive picture of the early- and intermediate-term changes in each community that are

needed to reach a long-term goal articulated by the community” (Anderson, A. 2005) It works like a roadmap of an area with different accesses to destinations, based on your speed, interest areas to visit and what your end goals are. If you proceed on your journey reaching the beginning landmarks and the intermediate landmarks, that will give you a clearer picture of whether you are taking the right road. (www.theoryofchange.org) what-is-Theory-of-change/#4) Anderson, Andrea; Harvard Family Research Project. Volume XI, Number 2, Summer 2005

The study of change and questions of how to manifest change for individuals and organizations have baffled experts (Deal, 1985; Kimberly and Quinn, 1984) Our assumptions about how change occurs, range from Darwin Gradualism, to punctuated equilibrium, which is that a species remains basically static and then abruptly there is a paradigm transformation like in Darwin’s thinking, where the species makes a shift and the species looks and feels different than before.

I personally subscribe to both change models, depending on what we are examining. In training leaders for large organizations, the first part of our work was to make sure we had a covenant on the long-term goals of the organization. Of course, this came after many interviews with stakeholders from all levels of the organization. We then created a critical path model and could change our assumptions as we moved through the program. The Montessori Teacher Training is quite consistent in what it expects from its teachers.

Montessori’s dominant oral tradition has been prominent since 1909 and focuses on culture, ideology and technique (Hiebert, Gallimore, & Stigler 2002) in learning to teach. Although there are no agreed upon definitions of theories of change, they can be used as a map toward supporting changes of all kinds. Therefore, it is important to make sure the Theory/s of Change we use in this paper make sense “as a response to analysis of the context, the problem/question and the changes needed. “using theory of change

as a framework to test assumptions, demonstrate impact and learn from it. (Isabel Vogal for the UK Department of International Development)

In all assessments for Montessori teacher training, there is a need for critical reflection as the process moves forward. Because the most important aspect of the training will depend on self- reflection and self-assessment. Theory of change can innovate and adapt to the changing dynamic conditions through making assumptions explicit and transparent at all steps of the process. Which assumptions are to be held? Which assumptions can be made in all the trainings? Montessori is an international model of childhood education, and there is a need for consistency as well as flexibility based on the culture where the program is delivered. When assumptions and near term and intermediate term goals are clear, they inform the design and implementation of the programs.

When plotting a theory of change to assess the long-term goals, the early and intermediate term changes are necessary to monitor to determine if the assumptions that were made originally are accurate, whether the logic (or tactics) continues to make sense and whether a change in the theory is necessary to go the next step. Because Theory of Change (TOC) is also a tool that can be used in many different contexts, ranging from large scale complex social action initiatives to assessing teacher training in the Montessori Method. we will utilize Theory of Change to assess the results of Montessori Teacher Training based on the stated goals of teacher performance.

I am not going to discuss the actual results of the Montessori educational model in terms how well the children in the program do, but rather will focus on the expected results of the teacher training.

I believe the philosopher Fritjof Capra in his description of a paradigm, makes sense when we look at an assessment of Montessori Teachers. “A paradigm is a constellation of concepts, values, perceptions and practices, shared by a community that forms a particular vision of reality that is the basis of the way the

community organizes itself. It's necessary for a paradigm to be shared by a community. A single person can have a worldview, but a paradigm is shared by a community." (The Web of Life, New York, Anchor Books, 1996) (Giles Hutchins, The nature of business April 12, 2014)

The Montessori approach to assessment and reporting is based on the belief that each child is a competent learner, born ready to learn from the people and the cultural and material environment around them. (Roemer, Kathy Lynn, May 1999 Dissertation EDD University of Memphis)

The guidelines for Montessori Elementary Teachers are clear in that they are to assess student's progress and achievement. However, this is not very well defined since it is very difficult to assess. Some Montessori Teachers use traditional measures such as standardized achievement tests and tests of memory and recall (McKenzie, 1998) Other Montessori Teachers use portfolios and individualized discussions and conferences for assessment.

In a telephone conversation with Ann Velasco, Director of Training for Southwest Institute for Montessori Studies, she said the most difficult aspect of the Montessori Teacher Training is the teachers need to learn about themselves. The two main foci of the training that I will look at with the Theory of Change are their main role which is setting the context of the classroom and being an observer. She said they need to come into the classroom every day with a fresh perspective, every day is a new day. Self-reflection and self-assessment are the pillars of their responsibilities. They have no hard and fast assessments for the teachers.

In a Montessori classroom, observation is one of the primary roles of the teacher. (Neubert, 1992). Observation is basic and significant to the Montessori method. Dr. Montessori referred to her approach as a "scientific pedagogy" (Montessori, 1962, p.21) with its foundation based on observation and experimentation. Teachers act more like facilitators and have the role of affirming each individual student in the classroom

The steps in the Theory of Change:

- 1. Start with what the teachers to learn. Identify a long-term goal. The skills based training of keeping a portfolio for each child, learning what the district needs for reporting, keeping an organizational schedule, assessing each child as they move along the pathway for their grade level.
- 2. Conduct “backwards mapping” to identify the preconditions necessary to achieve that goal. This is not done in the training. However, what does it take to become judgment free? What are the skills that are needed to observe without making conclusions and pinning labels on each child?
- 3. Identify the interventions that your initiative will perform to create these preconditions. “Theory of change is best kept flexible not prescribed” (Vogel, Isabel, April 2012) Because Theory of Change is both a process and a product, the decision of what it is depends on the steps in the process. It is most effective when overlaid on already existing processes, to support critical thinking throughout. The Montessori Teacher Training is individually prescribed within a global context and culture.

As discussed previously, the individual teacher spends most of her/his training learning about themselves as part of a larger universal culture so they can approach each child without positive or negative assumptions. In my interview with a Montessori trainer, she states this is the most difficult and most important aspect of the training.

- 4. Develop indicators for each precondition that will be used to assess the performance of the interventions. There are monthly self-assessments each teacher fills out. And, they are sent to observe in an already productive and successful setting. They may observe every day until they can approach

the classroom and the students in the classroom without their own assumptions as a precondition.

- 5. Write a narrative that can be used to summarize the various moving parts in your theory. There is a portfolio for each child that continues throughout their journey.

The Montessori approach to assessment and reporting reflect its pedagogy and philosophy, which is based on the belief that each child is a competent learner, born ready to learn from the people, cultural and material environment around them. (Roemer, Kathy Lynn, May 1999 Dissertation EDD, University of Memphis.)

The long-term goal for all Montessori Teachers is to create an environment/a context where they can be facilitators of the learning process for the educational process each child experiences.

The assumptions that will support the long-term goal seem to be as follows:

- Each teacher can be a competent learner.
- Each teacher can let go of judgements about themselves and their students.
- Conduct “backward mapping” to identify the preconditions necessary to achieve that goal

This could be presented in Critical Path sequencing of stages determining the minimum time needed for certain tasks, moving backward. I can see the first step of the Theory of Change of identifying the long-term goal of teachers to be able to create the appropriate context/environment for the students.

Accountability of meeting standards and ensuring the educational growth of every child has influenced the Montessori Method of Teaching. The public schools are held to meet or exceed assessment scores of all students in the school district. Montessori

needs to prove ensured educational growth for all students educated through the Montessori Method without being competitive.

Although working with the Theory of Change can be challenging, as it has been for me, its framework can evaluate potential issues before they are a problem. With a context of open communication and intimate discussion of each teacher's inner life as an intermediate goal in Montessori Training, an open approach to learning is welcomed.

Is Montessori a reform model of training and learning? (Argyris, C, 2000) Based on the emphasis of teachers being responsible for creating the context and environment of the classroom, it makes sense to look at the setting in which they work to see how Theories of Change can support their work. (Elmore, R. 2004) Many standard school reform practices in traditional settings seem to be lacking in the core instructional goals of the teacher. They were more focused on student outcomes and achievement levels. (Cross City Campaign, 2005, p.23) Of course, this is crucial. Chicago, Milwaukee and Seattle all had their focus on standardized results. They were not focused on the classroom culture. "The standards were rarely connected to changes in instruction. (Cross City Campaign, 2005, p.69)

Michael Fullan makes the case that Theories of Change need an upgrade to Theories of Action (p.8, Centre for Strategic Education, 2006) He believes there needs to be a focus on motivation with an emphasis on moral purpose. Montessori Teacher Education certainly emphasizes motivation and moral purpose. The rest of his bullet points are capacity; resources; peer and leadership support, and identity. His belief that most theories of change are weak on capacity building does not hold true in the Montessori Teacher Training.

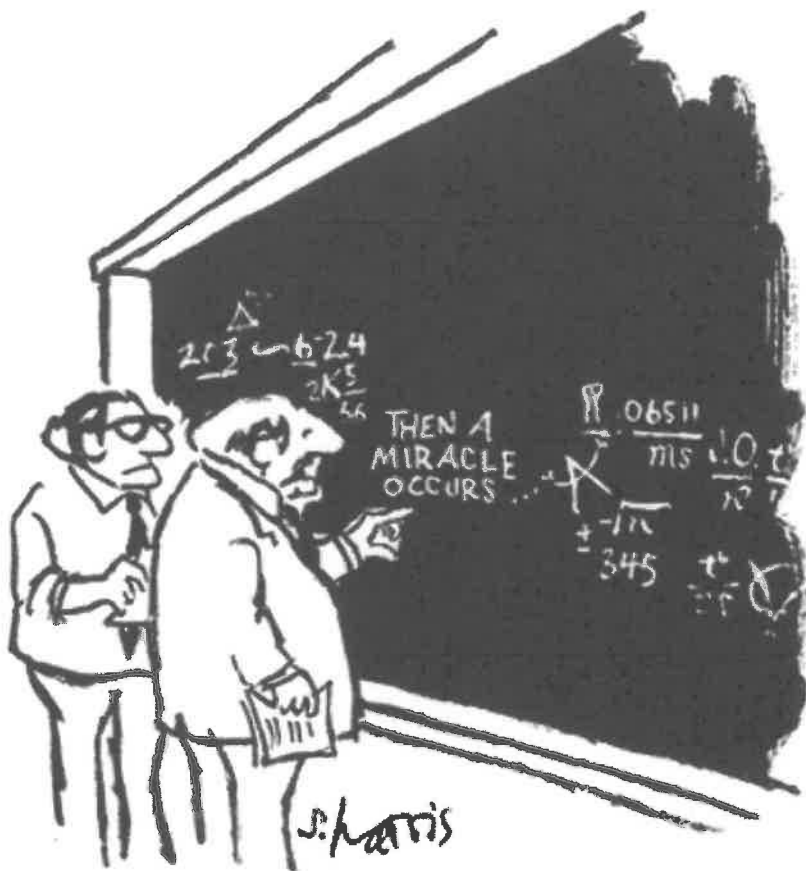
His Theories of Action upgrade where people learn in context, he says, "changes the very context itself. Contexts do improve. He also emphasizes the need for reflective action. Again, Montessori Teacher Training was made for his Theory of Action.

The following pages are an appendix to the paper:

P. 18, A cartoon which I thought made total sense as I wrote this paper.

P. 19-21, A Model for Change that I developed while CEO at Educational Discoveries, a Leadership and Development Company

P. 23, An activity that could foster Change in the Classroom



"I think you should be more explicit here in step two."

Theory of Change Academic Formula

Model for Change – Judith Orloff M.Ed. – Developed when CEO of Educational Discoveries, 2001

1. Go Getter (Seeker) - The Seeker's job is to navigate through the Model for Change (or whatever we decide to call it). They understand that change comes only after moving through a process, and they must be willing to experience uncertainty around how they have been conditioned to respond and react.

2. Support (Supporter) - The Supporter is a source of strength for the Seeker. It reminds the Seeker of their commitment and keeps them grounded and connected to their vision through any chaos. The Supporter is not afraid to say things as they are, nor is it afraid of any reactions that may take place.

3. Intention - Always aligns with the will of the Seeker, no matter where it leads. It will always yield to the Seeker's task.

4. Business as Usual-Status quo- It is an established and conservative way of doing things. It knows what has always worked in the past and has no interest in change.

5. Decision to Change - There is a recognition of the need to change, whether it is prompted by an inner desire or an external situation.

6. Resistance - Resistance is the result of a decision to change. It comes from fear of loss and seems rigid and immovable.

7. Order - It appears rational because it assesses the risks of moving into unfamiliar territory that always comes with change. Order wants everything to stay the same.

8. Chaos - Chaos is the catalyst for change and is filled with the unknown. The Seeker finds themselves pulled between the powers of order and chaos.

9. Reaction - Reaction is what occurs when we feel threatened and are not aware of the feelings we are trying to protect. It is a powerful force because it is coming from the past instead of allowing the truth of the moment to happen.

10. Illusion - It represents what is most familiar. It likes to be comfortable and stays in state of “everything is the way it should be.”

11. Crisis - Crisis is the moment of truth. As Danger, it threatens the existence of the Seeker, and as Opportunity it propels the Seeker to get back on track.

12. Congruence - Walking the talk. When attitudes and actions are consistent with purpose and vision.

13. Ability to Receive New Information - Open-Minded?) - This is one of the most essential skills needed for change. It allows new information in to dissolve conditioned responses and allow for new solutions.

14. Synergy (Harmony or Unity) - When two or more energies come together to achieve a higher goal.

15. Chaos of Creation

- As risk
- As naked truth
- As paradox
- As the unknown
- As fear

As excitement

Personal Freedom - If the Seeker utilizes choice, change, and power in the right ways, personal freedom will come as a result. It is the most powerful way of being that the Seeker has, manifesting itself as empowerment, partnering, and spontaneity.

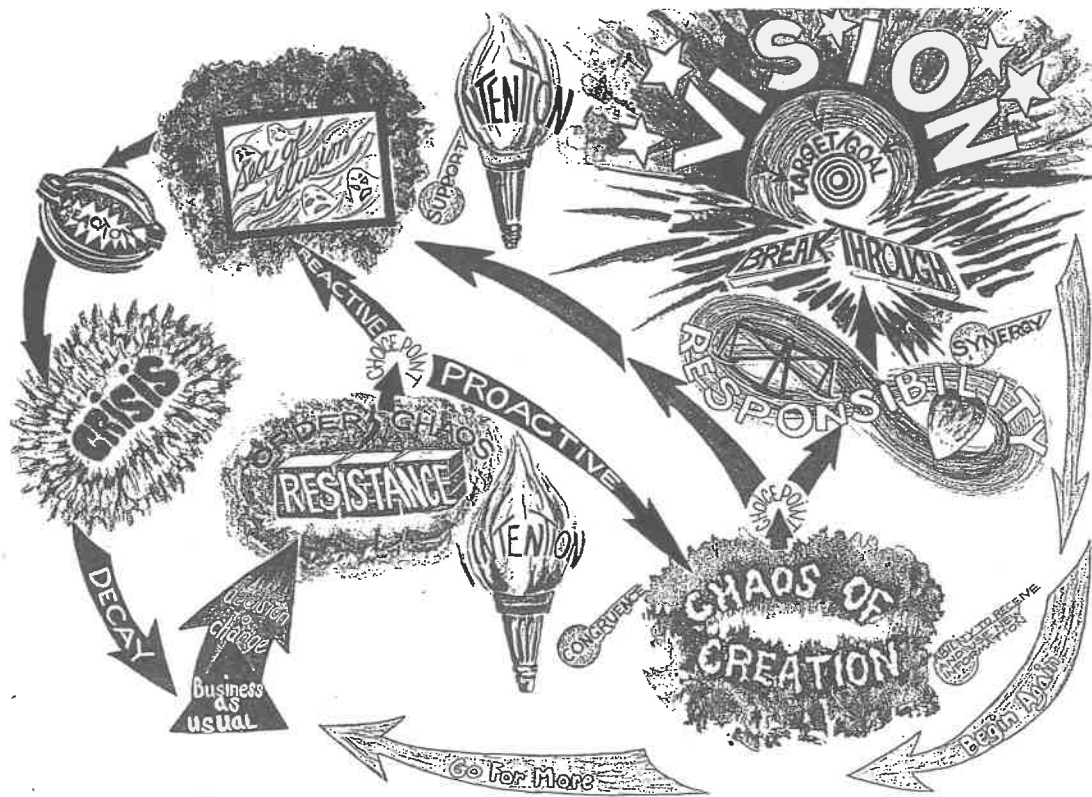
17. Personal Responsibility - Personal Responsibility sees itself as the source of its results. It knows that it is the source and authority of its experiences.

18. Objectives - Objectives are specific, measurable targets that the Seeker aims for. They measure whether the Seeker is on track toward their mission and vision.

19. Breakthrough - The breakthrough is the last barrier between the Seeker and change. In order for the breakthrough to occur, the Seeker must let go of the past.

20. Mission - The Mission is the purpose of the organization, the reason why it exists. It encompasses the values and culture of the organization.

21. Vision - It is the picture of the Seeker's purpose brought to life. It is the guiding light that continuously inspires the Seeker to realize their highest purpose.



MODEL FOR CHANGE

Championing Change Activity Feedback Form

Take Ownership
Remove Barriers
Manage Risk
Foster New Ideas and Innovation

Criteria	January	April	July	October	Final Assessment
Was the strategy clearly presented?					
Were the roles and responsibilities articulated?					
Were the barriers to success removed?					
Were the risks identified and accounted for?					
Was it innovative?					
Was the plan flexible in terms of expanding the possibilities for others to be innovative and empowered?					
Were you moved to take ownership for the change?					

I believe this activity could support Theories of Change to be
Theories of Action in any Teacher Training Session

Judith Orloff, M.Ed.

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Constructive Goal Setting and Feedback; Irinyl, Michelle

Montessori Approach vs. Traditional Approach to Assessment

Montessori Guide

No.	Slide – suggest very colorful graphics, pictures and video	Talking Points – suggestions on topics to cover while slide is shown.
1	Opening	
2	Children with special needs are just like you in many ways. But they may be lacking your: • Physical coordination • Mental capacity or • Emotional stability	Right here in our Jewish community there are many children with special needs. They may be learning disabled, unable to see or hear or be mentally impaired. There are many different reasons why children of all ages have special needs.
3	In addition to the love and support these children receive at home, they need: • Education, • Therapy and • A Social life	Maybe you've had children with special needs in your classes, or they may go to another school that is designed to meet their needs. Therapy is something you may be familiar with; it's usually a regular session where a child goes to get the physical or emotional support they need from a professional. These two needs are pretty easy for parents to fill; they can find the right school and therapist for their son or daughter. <i>But what about social needs?</i>
4	Everybody needs friends! That's why we created the Friendship Circle.	Let's see a show of hands. How many of you hung out with friends over the weekend? How many talked to a friend on the phone last night? Sometimes it's difficult for a child with special needs to make a connection with other kids. That's why we created the Friendship Circle. The Friendship Circle is about teens like you getting together with children with special needs.
5	The Friendship Circle has three great programs: 1. Friends at Home 2. Children's Circle 3. Holiday and Camp Programs	The Friendship Circle offers you a choice. You can get involved a little or a lot. And there are special trips just for volunteers (more on that later). I will review each of these three programs because you may just find a place for yourself in one of them.
6	Friends at Home You and a friend visit a child weekly	Hey, this is a big commitment with a huge payoff! You pair up with a friend of yours and together you visit a child in his or her home once a week. Don't worry about whether you can do it – you'll be trained before you begin your work as a friend and mentor. The payoff? An amazing feeling of pride and satisfaction. The 100 teens already doing it love it!
7	Children's Circle Sunday is party time	This is fun! For 15 Sundays during the school year the whole group comes together. You will volunteer to be with other teens

		and the children while they participate in some of their (and your) favorite activities like music, art, storytelling and sports.
8	Holiday and Camp Programs Cool gatherings all year long	It's time to Celebrate! On Jewish Holidays children with special needs and their families join for festivities and traditions. Winter camps and other occasional programs are also held. Volunteers like you are needed for these events.
9	Here's a quick review: 1. Friends at Home 2. Children's Circle 3. Holiday and Camp Programs	Three programs. Three great opportunities for fun and mitzvah! Friends at Home – a weekly visit to a child Children's Circle – a large gathering on Sundays Holiday and Camp Programs – occasional group events.
10	Bonus! Special events for you.	Here are those special events I told you about. As a volunteer you get the rewards of being a friend and mentor, you get special training, great experience (impressive! looks good on college applications) plus free trips like rafting and skiing.
11	Remember: Be a friend!	What do you think, ready to join the Friendship Circle? Just sign up after this session and we'll call you to tell you more. If you're not ready to volunteer we still hope that you will keep in mind that children with special needs are a lot like you. They also need friends. Think about giving a big smile or lending a hand to someone whom may need your friendship today.
12	Final tied to opening	